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POE PART 1

GROUP 7

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Proposal content

1. Organization Overview

Name: Tree of Life Foundation

Brief History:

Founded in 2007 as a South African Trust and registered as a Public Benefit Organization (PBO), Tree of Life began with equity investments from two businessmen. For nearly a decade, it grew solely through returns. In 2016, the Foundation launched a Donor-Advised Fund (DAF) platform to accelerate its mission of sustainable charitable support.

Mission Statement:

"To build a substantial endowment fund whose returns allow predictable, sustainable funding for qualifying charities, NGOs, and ministries in South Africa and across Africa."

Vision Statement:

"To multiply charitable impact over time by investing donations wisely, enabling donors to see their contributions grow to support long-term, strategic change."

Target Audience:

- High-net-worth individuals and philanthropic investors seeking long-term impact
- Charities and NGOs in South Africa and Africa needing sustainable funding
- Faith-based donors aligned with Christian values and principles of giving

2. Website Goals and Objectives

Website Goals:

- **Increase visibility** of the Foundation's model of sustained impact through endowment investing
- **Drive donor engagement**, especially for DAFs
- **Attract and inform charities/NGOs** about eligibility and application process

- **Promote transparency** around governance and impact

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

- **Website traffic:** Unique visitors, page views, session duration
- **Donor actions:** Number of inquiries, DAF sign-ups or expressions of interest
- **Charity engagement:** Downloads of documentation, request submissions, application completions
- **Conversion rate:** Percentage of visitors taking desired actions (e.g., contacting via form, opening a fund)

3. Current Website Analysis

Strengths:

- Clear statement of long-term impact model (“What if a donation could ‘do good’ for longer?”)
- Transparent history and structure (PBO, establishment, donor fund model)
- Clean, minimal navigation with key sections (“About,” “Donor-Advised Fund,” “Who We Help”)

Weaknesses:

- No visible call-to-action buttons or clear user pathways for donors or charities
- Limited interactive elements (e.g., forms, downloadable impact reports, testimonials)
- Sparse visual hierarchy—could benefit from clearer layout or wireframing to guide journeys

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Essential Features:

- **Home:** Hero messaging (impact-driven), quick links to “Support us,” “Our focus area,” “Learn more”
- **About Us:** History, mission & vision, governance structure, FAQs
- **Donor-Advised-Fund:** Benefits, process, contact form, downloadable brochure
- **(“Who We Help”):** Overview of qualifying organizations, application process, success stories and partnerships
- **Resources:** Annual reports, investment returns, distribution statistics (e.g., % of capital distributed), testimonials
- **Gallery:** Impactful pictures telling a story of the work that is done by the organization
- **Contact Us:** Simple form for inquiries, office details, maybe a newsletter signup

Desired Functionality:

- Intuitive navigation and breadcrumb structure
- Downloadable PDF brochures and fund application packs
- Contact forms with autoreply and categorization (Donor vs Charity)
- Mobile-responsive design
- CMS to allow updates (e.g., reports, news)

5. Design and User Experience

Design Aesthetic:

- **Theme:** Professional yet approachable; emphasizes philanthropy and transformation.
- **Imagery:** High-quality photos of diverse people, South African communities, and pictures of hope.

Colour Scheme:

- **Earth-tones:** Deep Forest green (#2C5F2D) for trust, growth
- **Gold / warm amber** (#D4AF37) for legacy, value

- **Neutral soft grey** (#F5F5F5) as background for clean readability

Typography:

- **Headers: Poppins Bold** (Modern, readable).
- **Body Text: Open Sans Regular** (Accessible, scalable).
- **Hierarchy:**
 - H1: 40px (Page titles).
 - H2: 28px (Section headers).
 - Body: 16px (Default text).

Layout and Design Approach:

- Visual hierarchy guiding users (hero → overview → CTAs)
- Consistent branding—leaf/tree motif subtly used in section breaks or icons
- Ample whitespace, visual break between sections
- Responsive grid layout with key funnel flows

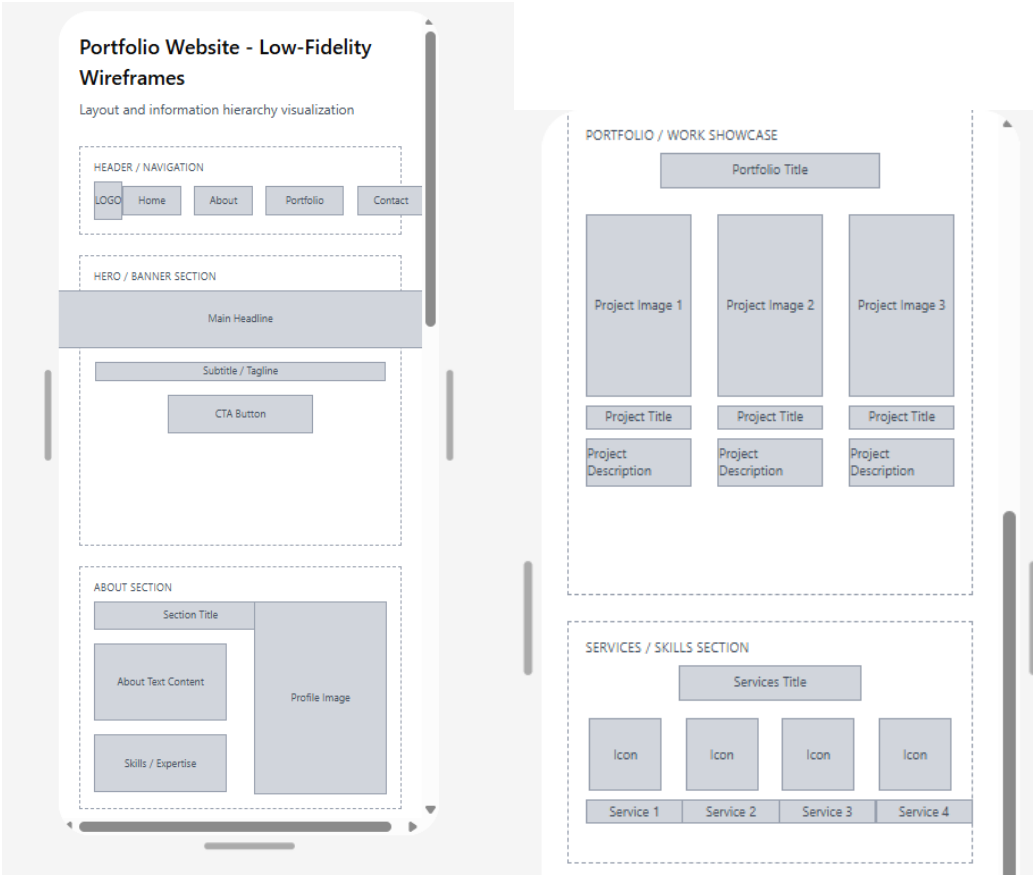
Wireframes Overview (Low-Fidelity):

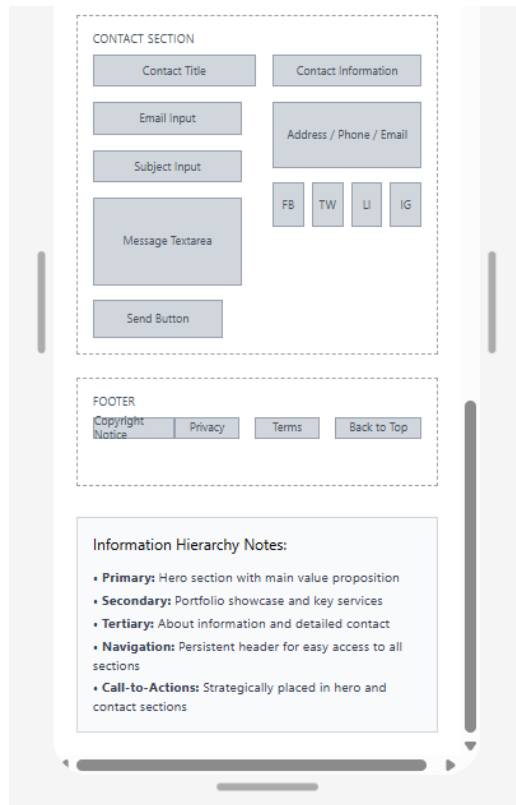
- **Hero section:** Full-width banner with tagline (“Your donation, growing impact over time”), two CTA buttons (“Learn How” / “Open a Fund”)
- **Mid-page:** Three-panel feature overview (How It Works, Donor Benefits, Charity Support) with icons
- **Lower section:** Downloadable resources pack, contact form teaser
- **Footer:** Links, governance, social proof, contact info

User Experience Considerations:

- Clear CTAs: “Invest in Impact,” “Apply for Funding,” “Download Info Pack”
- Sticky navigation or quick links on longer pages
- Breadcrumbs for user orientation
- Accessibility: sufficient contrast, alt text, accessible forms

Low-fidelity wireframes visuals:





6. Technical Requirements

Hosting & Domain

- **Domain Name:** <https://tol.org.za/> (already registered, but renewal may be required).
- **Hosting Provider:**
 - **Recommended:** SiteGround (optimized for WordPress) or AWS Lightsail (scalable for LMS).
 - **Key Features Needed:**
 - SSL certificate (for secure donations/logins).
 - South African server location (faster load times).
 - 99.9% uptime guarantee.

Programming Languages & Frameworks

- **Frontend:**
 - HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (Vanilla + React for interactive elements like course filters).
- **Backend:**
 - PHP (for WordPress CMS) or Node.js (if custom LMS is developed).
- **CMS:**
 - WordPress + LearnDash (for LMS functionality) or Moodle (open-source alternative).
- **Integrations:**
 - Payment Gateway: PayFast (South Africa-friendly).
 - SEO: Yoast SEO plugin.
 - Accessibility: WP Accessibility Helper plugin.

7. Timeline and Milestones

Total Duration: 8 weeks (aligned with submission deadlines).

Milestone	Week
Project kickoff & requirements	1
Research & sitemap approval	2
Wireframing & initial design	3–4
Prototype & CMS setup	5
Content population & reviews	6
Testing (UX, responsiveness, forms)	7
Launch & training for client	8

8. Budget

Estimated, realistic, South African context

Development & Design: R25,000–R35,000 (depending on complexity)

Hosting & Domain (annual): R2,000 (managed hosting with SSL)

Maintenance (annual): R5,000 (updates, analytics, CMS support)

Total first-year estimate: R32,000–R42,000

Note: Costs assume a freelance developer rate; NGO discounts may apply.

9. References

1. **Tree Of Life Existing Website:** <https://tol.org.za> (for content audit).
2. **LearnDash Documentation:** <https://www.learndash.com> (LMS integration).
3. **WCAG 2.1 Guidelines:** <https://www.w3.org/WAI/> (accessibility standards).
4. **Google Lighthouse:** <https://developers.google.com/web/tools/lighthouse> (performance metrics).

Content research and sourcing

Organisation's Website

- **Overview & Mission:** TOL is a Christian, Public Benefit Organisation founded in 2007 in South Africa, focused on building an endowment fund to deliver sustainable, long-term support to charities.
- **Key Objectives:**
 - Wise investment for impact beyond financial returns.
 - Establishing an endowment for predictable, sustainable giving.
 - Building a donor-advised fund (DAF) to enable collective donor capital.

- **Donor-Advised Fund (DAF):** TOL launched its DAF platform in 2016, offering various investment portfolios—short-, medium-, and long-term, including private equity and impact investments.
- **Beneficiaries (“Who We Help”):** A vetted list of partner organisations such as Acres of Love, Agapé Family Ministries, Eagles Rising Leadership Academy, and many others appear on the site.
- **Details & Downloads:** You can access brochures and detailed documents such as the DAF platform PDF with nuanced info on fees, distributions, and portfolio types

Social Media

- The TOL’s social platforms mostly mirror their website content —especially around announcements, partner stories, and impact narratives. Their Facebook and Instagram have updates and community engagements that happen frequently opposed to the website since the website cannot be altered as frequently as putting up a post.

Public Domain & Creative Commons Resources

- For my page I will be using the following sourcing visuals (images/icons):
 - **Free image sources:** Unsplash.
 - **Icons & fonts:** FontAwesome.
 - **TOL’s branding** (logo).

Original Content

- The existing materials fall short hence I will be crafting my own:

- **Page-specific writing:** I will start off with a “How to Open a Fund” page and could include user-friendly step-by-step instructions based on the brochure of the website.
- **Charity spotlights:** The next thing I would do is to develop short-impact profiles for charities like Acres of Love (“rescue children, operate 30 Forever Family Homes... Johannesburg, Benoni, and Cape Town”).
- **Investment strategy summaries:** Lastly, I would break down TOL’s portfolio categories (impact, private equity, medium/short-term) in an approachable language.

Website structure and planning

Sitemap

Website Structure

Visual representation of the site hierarchy and page relationships

